



to your eye and neck. However, in bright sunlight, LCDs typically do not perform well, and you will need a large enough viewfinder that you can comfortably place your eye to without needing to squint. Typically, you can play back your shots directly in the viewfinder and LCD. An LCD screen of 2.5 inches (measured diagonally from corner to opposite corner) will be sufficient to monitor your shots, though you might want to consider going with a camcorder with a larger LCD (3-inch) if your budget permits.

1.2.12 Progressive Vs. Interlaced Scanning

Video is generally recorded at about 30 frames per second. Each video frame consists of “fields of resolution.” That is, each frame is further divided into a number of horizontal lines of resolution. These lines of resolution give the picture its clarity and vibrancy of colours. To understand this difference in quality, think of VHS video which is in the 240 to 270 lines of resolution range, TV, which is about 330 lines of resolution, and DVD, which approaches 500 lines of resolution. The process of capturing these lines is called scanning. There are two types of scanning: Interlaced and Progressive.

In interlaced scanning, there are two fields of data recorded for each frame. Each field consists of an alternating line of resolution that is recorded alternately. Once both the lines are captured, the frame is said to be created. Thus, the frame consists of two inter-